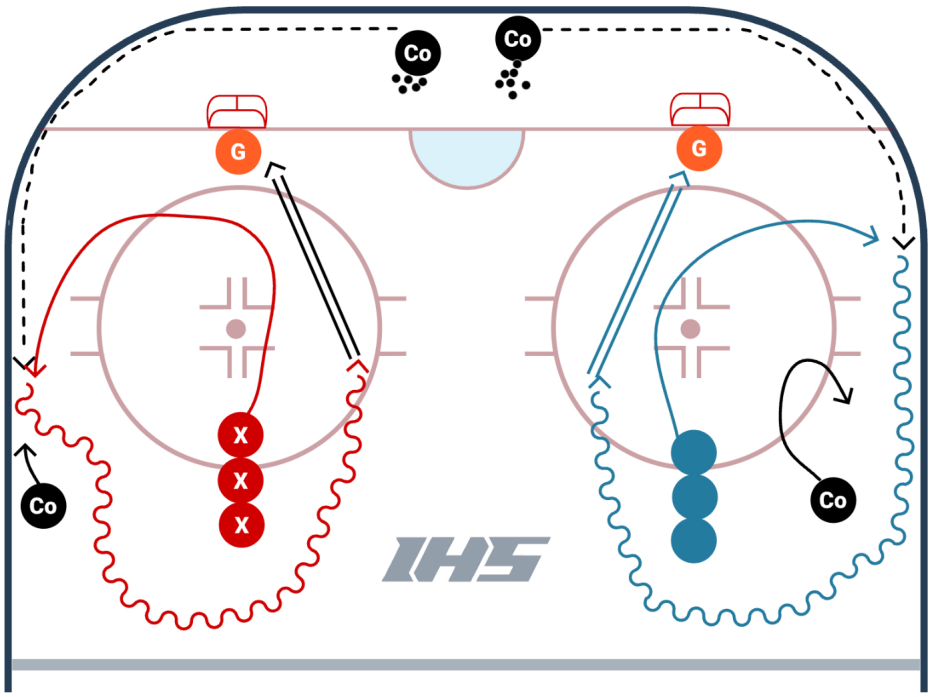
MERRIMACK WALL DRILL

Time: **Station:**



This drill is a great half ice drill to work on quickly handling rims off the wall and making a play as soon as possible. This drill works for both forwards and defensemen.

SETUP:

- To set up this drill there should be a line of players starting at the tops of the circles.
- A coach will be on the middle hashmarks with a pile of pucks and the other coach will be next to the line of players ready to force a decision on the player coming up the wall.
- A goalie will be in the net that has been placed in line with the dots.

HOW THIS DRILL WORKS:

- To start the drill, the coach will rim the puck behind the net. The first player in line will time it and meet the puck along the wall.
- After the player handles the puck off the wall with their eyes up, they will react to where the coach is. If they are off the wall, then the player will do a quick mohawk and protect the puck up the wall (OPTION 1). If the Coach is along the wall, then the player will make a quick move to the middle (OPTION 2).
- After the player makes the move according to their coach's position, they will skate overspeed with the puck around the line of player and take a quick shot before the tops of the circles.

COACHING POINTS:

- In this drill, handling rims is the most important piece. Being able to meet the puck along the wall and quickly gain control of it helps immensely when it comes to game-time situations.
- Another important thing is keeping the eyes up; this comes into play when reading the coaches position and being able to depict what move they need to make immediately.